

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT · TAKE-HOME PACKET

Your Page, Rebuilt

Accessibility for the Modern Learner: Designing Engaging
Instruction for Higher Education Mathematics

Session: Friday, July 17, 2026 · 6:00 PM Central · Zoom

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Participant copy. Everything from the session is in here, in the order you'll use it.

START HERE

How This Packet Works

Five parts, in the order you'll actually use them: understand the system once, build at whatever tier suits you, verify every page, then reach for the genre playbook that matches the page in front of you. Nothing here requires you to remember the session.

The privacy rule comes before everything: never paste student names, student work, or grades into a public AI model. Course content only.

The one habit everything hangs on: however a page gets built, the published page gets verified against the four-point Accessibility Checklist in Part 3. The AI saying a page is accessible is not evidence that it is. The audit belongs to the page, not the template.

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The shared drive folder

The folder linked in my follow-up email holds the copy-paste source files: the before/after pair (01, 02), the prompt frame (03), the checklist (04), the three paste blocks (05–07), the template menu (09), the corrected announcement starter template, and the two full-length PD handouts this packet condenses, if you ever want the long version. **Copy code from the folder files, never from this PDF.** PDFs quietly mangle quotation marks and whitespace, and mangled quotes are the number one cause of broken pastes.

PART 1

The System

Understand this once and every page gets easier.

Students skip dense pages, and the cost lands on you: the repeated emails, the missed deadlines, the "what's on the test?" messages the night before an exam. That is a design problem, and it has a design solution. But before building anything, one rule governs all of it.

The one rule: Canvas strips things

When you save a page, Canvas runs it through a sanitizer that silently deletes anything it considers unsafe. This is why beautiful AI-generated pages can turn into plain text after pasting: the AI wrote good HTML for the open web, not for Canvas. What survives and what doesn't:

Feature	Survives?	What to do instead
<code><script></code> / any JavaScript	No	Design with zero JS. Static only.
<code><style></code> blocks / your own CSS classes	No	Put every style inline: <code>style="..."</code> on each element.
External fonts (Google Fonts)	No	System stacks: Georgia, serif or Arial, sans-serif.
<code><html>/<head>/<body></code> wrappers	No	A content fragment; one outer <code><div></code> at most.
@media queries, :hover, CSS variables	No	Hardcoded values; for mobile layouts use flex-wrap or grid auto-fit.
Inline styles (<code>style="..."</code>)	Yes	This is the entire styling toolkit. Embrace it.
Anchor links (<code>href="#videos"</code>)	Yes	The one navigation technique Canvas reliably keeps.
<code><iframe></code> video embeds	Yes	YuJa and YouTube embeds work; make them responsive (Part 4).
<code><table></code>	Yes	

		For data, with headers and a caption. Never for page layout.
Canvas's own built-in classes (btn, icon-, the column grid, tabs)	Yes	The one sanctioned exception to "no classes": Canvas supplies and keeps these itself.
<details> collapsible sections	Test it	Varies by institution. Paste-test on an unpublished page first.
letter-spacing, text-transform, font-weight, box-shadow (even inline)	Test it	Some institutions strip these. Fallbacks: , TYPED CAPITALS, shadow-free design.

When a stripped tag fails, it usually fails soft: the content survives, the styling doesn't. A broken page is ugly, not empty. Still, paste-test new techniques on an unpublished page before building a course on them.

The constraint block: tell the AI the rules first

The fix for all of the above is one paragraph you paste at the start of any AI conversation about Canvas content, before the AI writes a single line. It converts hours of troubleshooting into zero. This is the only place it's printed in this packet; it also lives at the top of the prompt frame and the announcement template in the drive folder.

```
Before we build this, hard constraints for Canvas's editor: when
Canvas saves content it strips <style> blocks, external font imports,
<script> tags, and <html>/<head>/<body> wrappers. Only inline
style="..." attributes on individual elements survive. So:
1. No <style> block -- every rule goes inline on the element itself.
2. No external fonts -- use system stacks (Georgia,serif or
   Arial,sans-serif).
3. No CSS variables -- hardcode real values on each element.
4. No :hover / pseudo-classes -- static styling only.
5. No @media queries -- for mobile-friendly layouts use
   display:flex;flex-wrap:wrap or grid repeat(auto-fit,minmax(...)).
6. No JavaScript -- everything static.
7. No page wrapper -- output a content fragment; one outer <div> max.
8. Whole-pixel values only (no 0.5px borders).
9. Headings are real heading tags in logical order, starting at <h2>
   (Canvas renders the page or announcement title as the h1).
Give me the result as a single HTML fragment I can paste into the
Canvas HTML editor.
```

The four-step loop

Every AI-built page follows the same loop, and the loop is the transferable skill:

1. **Describe.** Purpose, complete content as a numbered list (dates, rules, links, times — everything), a few style adjectives, and the constraint block. Complete content up front is the single biggest time-saver; design iterates cheaply, missing content means rework. End with "any questions before we begin?" and answer what the AI asks.
2. **Preview in a browser first.** Open the AI's HTML in Chrome or Safari and judge layout and wording there, before Canvas enters the picture.
3. **Paste via the HTML editor.** In the page editor, use the `</>` HTML view (in the editor's menu: **View**, then the HTML Editor), paste the whole fragment, and save from that view. The visual editor's paste cleanup is more destructive than the HTML editor's; paste in HTML view.
4. **Screenshot what survived and report back.** Whatever Canvas renders, screenshot it to the AI with a precise note ("the sections render expanded," "the tiles

stacked on my phone"). Precise failure reports produce precise fixes. Two or three rounds is normal for a new template; a template that survives once is reusable all semester.

Three habits that make the loop pay: iterate in specifics, not vibes ("change five dots to four, make the third green") · ask the AI for trade-offs, not just artifacts ("what are the downsides of this approach?") · ask for loud [PLACEHOLDERS] everywhere something changes weekly, then search the code for "[" before posting.

PART 2

Build

Three tiers. Enter anywhere; every tier produces a passing page.

You do not have to start with the AI. The on-ramp has three tiers, and any tier produces a checklist-passing page. Enter wherever you're comfortable; move up when a tier stops being enough.

Tier	What it is	Reach for it when
1 • Canvas built-ins	Canvas's own editor styles plus its built-in classes: buttons (btn), icon links (icon-video), the column grid, tabs.	You want improvement today with zero pasting. Real headings, descriptive links, and one button already beat most pages.
2 • Paste-ready blocks	The three blocks in this part plus the nine-pattern Template Menu. Pre-built, audited, fill-in-the-brackets.	You want a designed page in minutes without talking to an AI at all.
3 • The prompt frame	Describe your page in plain English; the AI writes Canvas-ready HTML to your constraints.	Your page doesn't match any template, or you're ready to build your own library.

The paste routine, same at every tier: open your page, click **Edit**; in the editor's menu bar click **View**, then choose the **HTML Editor** (the `</>` icon does the same thing). Paste where you want the pattern, fill every [BRACKET], **Save**, then verify against the checklist in Part 3.

The AI Prompt Frame

The AI Prompt Frame

Rebuild a Canvas page by describing it in plain English

PRIVACY RULE — READ FIRST: Never paste student names, student work, or grades into a public AI model. Course content only.

How to use it

1. Fill in the three bracketed slots below and paste the whole thing into any current general-purpose AI model (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, or Copilot where your institution provides it — free tiers work).
 2. Copy the HTML it returns.
 3. In Canvas: open your page → **Edit** → click the `</>` icon (bottom-right of the editor) → paste → **Save**.
 4. Look at what survived. Then verify against the Accessibility Checklist. **The AI saying the page is accessible is not evidence that it is.**
-

The frame (copy from here down)

You are helping a college instructor rebuild a Canvas LMS page.
Rewrite the content below as a single block of Canvas-ready HTML.

Hard requirements:

- Inline CSS styles only. No `<style>` blocks, no `<script>`, no external classes or stylesheets, and no document wrapper (`<html>`, `<head>`, `<body>`). Canvas strips all of those on save.
- Headings are real heading tags in logical order, starting at `<h2>`, because Canvas renders the page title as the `h1`.
- Every text/background color pair must meet WCAG 4.5:1 contrast. Do not use opacity to lighten text.
- Every image gets an alt attribute written as `[DESCRIBE IMAGE]` for me to fill in myself.
- Link text says where the link goes. Never "click here."
- Emoji may decorate, but must never be the only carrier of meaning.

Layout I want: [banner / callout boxes / two-column resource list /
schedule table / etc.]

Style direction: [clean and minimal / bold headers / colors: ____]

Audience: college students who will likely read this on a phone.

Content to rebuild:

[PASTE YOUR PAGE TEXT HERE]

Part of "Accessibility for the Modern Learner" — Toolkit Section 5. Tier 3 of the page-design on-ramp: Canvas built-in styles → pre-built template blocks → this frame.

Three Paste-Ready Blocks

Fill the [BRACKETS], paste, save, verify. Copy the code from the drive folder, not this PDF.

BLOCK 1 · ANNOUNCEMENT / DEADLINE CALLOUT · SOURCE FILE 05

[ANNOUNCEMENT TITLE — e.g., Exam 2: Thursday, October 23]

[THE ONE THING THEY MUST NOT MISS — date, time, points]

[Two or three sentences of context. Keep the essential fact in the amber box above; use this space for the why and the how.]

[\[DESCRIPTIVE LINK TEXT — say where it goes, e.g., "Open the review assignment in MyMathLab"\]](#)

The amber box holds the one thing they must not miss; context goes below it, never inside it.

WEEK [#]

[WEEK TITLE — e.g., Rational Expressions]

This week at a glance

[Homework 4.1]	Due [day, date, time]
[Skill Check]	Due [day, date, time]

Your to-do list, in order

1. [Watch the section video — link with descriptive text]
2. [Read / attempt examples]
3. [Complete the homework — [Open Homework 4.1 in MyMathLab](#)]

Where to get help

- **Office hours:** [days, times, location]
- **Learning Center tutoring:** [days, times, location]

[DESCRIBE IMAGE — what does a student need to know from it?]

If you keep the optional figure, you write the alt text; if not, delete the whole img line.

VIDEO [1 OF 3] · ABOUT [5] MINUTES

[VIDEO TITLE — e.g., Worked Example: Solving Rational Equations]

[EMBED THE YUJA VIDEO HERE — Apps > YuJa in the editor, or paste the
iframe in HTML view]

Materials for this video

- [Download the slides for \[section\] \(PowerPoint\)](#)
- [Download the worked-example notes \(PDF\)](#)
- [Try the skill check for \[section\]](#)

Embed the YuJa video at the marked spot: Apps (the plug icon) then YuJa in the editor, or paste the iframe in the HTML view.

The Template Menu

Nine patterns, chosen by the problem each one solves.

The Template Menu

Pick by the problem, not the widget.

Every pattern below is paste-ready and ships checklist-passing. The paste routine is the same for all of them: open your page, click **Edit**, click the `</>` icon at the bottom-right of the editor, paste where you want the pattern, **Save**, then verify against the Accessibility Checklist. If you edit a pattern, re-verify; the audit belongs to the page, not the template.

About classes: the prompt frame says "inline styles only, no classes" because Canvas strips classes it does not recognize. A few patterns below use classes anyway (**btn**, **icon-**, the column grid, the tab menu). Those are Canvas's *own built-in* classes: Canvas supplies them, keeps them, and styles them itself. They are the one sanctioned exception. Any class that is not Canvas's own still gets stripped, so everything else here stays inline.

Which pattern for which problem

Decision guide: match the student problem to the pattern, and know when to reach past it.

The problem	Reach for	Think twice, because
One urgent, temporary announcement	Deadline alert	If it still matters next month, it is not an alert; use the key-info callout.
A fact every student must see all term	Key-info callout	Never bury it inside an accordion or a tab; hidden critical info fails its job.
A long reference page: FAQs, policies, rubrics	Accordion	Wrong for sequential material or anything deadline-critical.

The problem	Reach for	Think twice, because
Several parallel categories of similar weight	Tabbed menu	Tabs hide all panes but one, and in the Canvas mobile app they display as stacked sections. The accordion is sturdier.
Two things meant to be seen side by side	Two-column row	Never put sequential steps in columns; columns stack on phones and reading order shifts.
One clear action you want taken	Button	Three buttons in a row is a menu, not a call to action; keep one primary action per section.
A list of links students should scan fast	Icon links	Icons speed scanning but never carry meaning alone; the words do the work.
True rows-and-columns data	Data table	Tables are for data, never for page layout; screen readers announce them as data.
A small image beside a short text block	Image with wrapped text	Alt text is required, not optional, and meaning never travels by image alone.

1. Deadline alert — urgent and temporary

Choose it when something changed or something is due and the cost of missing it is real: a moved exam, a closing window. **Skip it when** the information is permanent; an alert that never leaves the page trains students to ignore alerts. Remove it once the moment passes.

Exam 2 moved to Room 214

Same day and time, Thursday, October 23. Only the room changed.

```
<div style="max-width: 800px; margin: 0 0 20px 0;">
  <div style="background: #9E1B1B; color: #FFFFFF; border-radius: 8px 8px 0 0; padding: 12px 18px;">
    <strong>[URGENT TITLE – what changed]</strong>
  </div>
  <div style="border: 1px solid #9E1B1B; border-top: none; border-radius: 0 0 8px 8px; padding: 14px 18px; background: #FFFFFF;">
    <p style="margin: 0; color: #24292F;">[One or two sentences: what to do, by when.]</p>
```

```
</div>
</div>
```

Checklist notes: white on #9E1B1B runs about 8:1; lead with a clear title, never color alone, and no all caps.

2. Key-info callout — important and permanent

Choose it when one fact must survive a skim: the due date on an assignment page, the calculator policy, the drop deadline. **Skip it when** you are tempted to stack three of them; a page of callouts has no callout. One per screen of content is the ceiling.

Review assignment due Tuesday, October 21, 11:59 PM — 20 points, in MyMathLab.

```
<div style="background: #FFF4D6; border-left: 6px solid #B58500; border-radius: 6px;
padding: 14px 18px; max-width: 800px;">
  <p style="margin: 0; color: #5C4400;"><strong>[THE FACT THEY MUST NOT MISS]</strong> –
  [one supporting line].</p>
</div>
```

Checklist notes: #5C4400 on #FFF4D6 runs about 8:1. Keep the essential fact in the box and the explanation in normal text below it.

3. Accordion — show on demand

Choose it when most readers need only one section of a long page: FAQs, week-by-week archives, rubric details, troubleshooting. It cuts scrolling without cutting content. **Skip it when** the content is sequential (steps belong in a numbered list, in the open) or critical (a due date inside a closed accordion is a due date missed; summarize essentials above, expand for detail). Versus tabs: this uses native HTML, so it behaves everywhere, including the Canvas mobile app.

Week 1 FAQ

Content appears only when the reader asks for it.

```

<details style="max-width: 800px; border: 1px solid #C9D1D9; border-radius: 6px; margin: 0
0 8px 0; background: #FFFFFF;">
  <summary style="padding: 12px 16px; font-weight: bold; color: #1B3A5C; cursor:
pointer;">[SECTION TITLE]</summary>
  <div style="padding: 0 16px 14px 16px; color: #24292F;">
    <p style="margin: 8px 0 0 0;">[Content revealed on demand.]</p>
  </div>
</details>

<!-- Duplicate the whole details block for each section. -->

```

Checklist notes: summaries are descriptive titles, not "More info"; nothing deadline-critical goes inside.

4. Tabbed menu — parallel categories (Canvas-native)

Choose it when a page holds several categories of similar weight that readers pick between rather than read through: Getting Started / Technology / Policies / Support. **Skip it when** readers need everything (tabs hide all panes but one) or when mobile matters most: the Canvas app does not run the tab script, so panes display as stacked sections there. That is a graceful failure, but if stacked-by-default is acceptable, the accordion was the better tool to begin with. Keep tab titles to one to three words, and make every id on the page unique.

```

<div class="enhanceable_content tabs">
  <ul>
    <li><a href="#tab-1">[Tab one]</a></li>
    <li><a href="#tab-2">[Tab two]</a></li>
    <li><a href="#tab-3">[Tab three]</a></li>
  </ul>
  <div id="tab-1"><p>[Tab one content]</p></div>
  <div id="tab-2"><p>[Tab two content]</p></div>
  <div id="tab-3"><p>[Tab three content]</p></div>
</div>

```

Checklist notes: renders as tabs only inside Canvas pages on the web; verify in Student View and once on a phone.

5. Two-column row — side-by-side comparison (Canvas-native)

Choose it when two things are meant to be compared or paired: a concept beside its worked example, a formula beside when to use it, this week beside next week. **Skip it when** the content is sequential; on a phone the columns stack top-to-bottom, and steps split across columns arrive out of order. Design for the stacked version first, since half your students will meet it that way.

```
<div class="grid-row">
  <div class="col-xs-12 col-md-12 col-lg-6">
    <h3>[Left heading]</h3>
    <p>[Left content]</p>
  </div>
  <div class="col-xs-12 col-md-12 col-lg-6">
    <h3>[Right heading]</h3>
    <p>[Right content]</p>
  </div>
</div>
```

Checklist notes: give each column its own real heading so screen readers announce the pair; columns render side by side only inside Canvas at desktop width.

6. Button — one clear action (Canvas-native)

Choose it when a section has one action you want taken: open the homework, start the quiz, book office hours. A button says "this is the thing to do here" the way a plain link cannot. **Skip it when** you are lining up three or more; a row of buttons is a menu wearing costumes, and the icon-link list below does that job better. Labels are verbs plus objects, never "Click here."

```
<p><a class="btn" href="[URL]">[Action label – e.g., Open Homework 4.1 in MyMathLab]</a></p>

<!-- Optional: add a Canvas icon to the button -->
<p><a class="btn icon-video" href="[URL]">Watch the Section 4.1 lecture</a></p>
```

Checklist notes: the button renders with Canvas's own styling inside Canvas; the label text carries the meaning with or without the icon.

7. Icon links — a scannable link list (Canvas-native)

Choose it when students face a list of links and need to find the right one fast; a consistent icon vocabulary (video, document, star) lets the eye sort before the brain reads.

Skip it when the icon would be doing the talking: Canvas icons live in the link's class, are invisible to screen readers, and disappear if the class ever changes, so the link text alone must still say everything. In Canvas these icon classes work only inside `<a>` tags.

```
<ul style="list-style: none; padding-left: 0; line-height: 2;">
  <li><a class="icon-star" href="[URL]">Start here: Week 1 checklist</a></li>
  <li><a class="icon-video" href="[URL]">Watch the course welcome video</a></li>
  <li><a class="icon-document" href="[URL]">Download the syllabus (PDF)</a></li>
  <li><a class="icon-flag" href="[URL]">Read this week's learning objectives</a></li>
</ul>
```

The full set of available icon class names is here: [Canvas icons list \(canvastemplate.com\)](https://canvaslms.com/docs/development/icon-classes).

8. Data table — true rows and columns

Choose it when the content really is tabular: a grading breakdown, a week-by-week schedule, exam logistics. The caption and header cells are what let a screen reader navigate it as data. **Skip it when** you are using a table to position things on the page; screen readers will announce your layout as a dataset, and the mobile experience collapses. Layout belongs to the two-column row; tables belong to data.

```
<table style="width: 100%; max-width: 800px; border-collapse: collapse;">
  <caption style="text-align: left; color: #4B5563; padding-bottom: 6px;">[What this table
shows]</caption>
  <thead>
    <tr>
      <th scope="col" style="border: 1px solid #C9D1D9; padding: 10px 14px; background:
#1B3A5C; color: #FFFFFF; text-align: left;">[Header 1]</th>
      <th scope="col" style="border: 1px solid #C9D1D9; padding: 10px 14px; background:
#1B3A5C; color: #FFFFFF; text-align: left;">[Header 2]</th>
    </tr>
  </thead>
  <tbody>
    <tr>
      <td style="border: 1px solid #C9D1D9; padding: 10px 14px; color: #24292F;">[Data]</
td>
      <td style="border: 1px solid #C9D1D9; padding: 10px 14px; color: #24292F;">[Data]</
td>
```

```
</tr>
</tbody>
</table>
```

Checklist notes: always a caption, always the scope="col" headers, never merged cells, white on #1B3A5C runs about 10:1.

9. Image with wrapped text

Choose it when a small image genuinely supports a short text block: a graph beside its interpretation, a calculator photo beside the exam policy. **Skip it when** the image would carry meaning the text does not repeat; students using screen readers, and students who skim, get the text either way. The clear-fix div at the end matters: without it, everything after the image wraps too.

```

<p style="color: #24292F;">[Paragraph text wraps beside the image.]</p>
<div style="clear: both;"></div>

<!-- For image right, text left: float: right; margin: 0 0 10px 20px; -->
```

Checklist notes: the alt slot is criterion 3; you write it, the AI's placeholder never survives to publication.

Where this menu fits: whole-page starters (the exam-info page, the weekly overview, the video card) are the assembled furniture; this menu is the parts bin. Start from a whole page when one fits your job, and reach in here when you are building or upgrading your own. Either way, the page you publish gets verified against the Accessibility Checklist — the audit belongs to the page, not the template.

PART 3

Verify

Every page, every time, before it publishes.

Accessibility Checklist

Verify before you publish — every page, every time

The four criteria below match the session outcome exactly. A page passes when all four pass.

- ☐ **1. Heading hierarchy.** Headings are real heading tags (<h2>, <h3>) in logical order, starting at <h2> — never bolded paragraph text doing a heading's job, and never an <h1> (Canvas already renders the page title as the h1). *Pass test:* Run the accessibility checker in the Canvas editor toolbar; the heading outline reads like a table of contents.
- ☐ **2. Color contrast.** Every text/background pair meets WCAG 4.5:1. Watch for the two usual offenders: light gray "fine print" and text lightened with opacity. *Pass test:* Check the actual hex pairs at webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker. Decorative borders and accents are exempt; readable text is not.
- ☐ **3. Alternative text.** Every image has meaningful alt text written by a human. *Pass test:* No [DESCRIBE IMAGE] placeholders survive, and no alt text merely repeats the file name. If the page has no images, this criterion passes by absence.
- ☐ **4. Canvas-ready inline styling.** The page saves and renders intact: inline styles only, no <style> or <script> blocks, no document wrapper — Canvas strips them, and what depends on them breaks silently. *Pass test:* Save, then view the page as a student (Student View), once on a phone or narrow window.

Riding along with every check: link text says where the link goes ("Get MyMathLab login help," never "click here"), and emoji decorate but never carry meaning alone.

The principle this list exists for: An AI's statement that a page is accessible is not evidence that it is. The prompt asks; this checklist verifies; you own what gets published.

Part of "Accessibility for the Modern Learner" — Toolkit Section 5.

PART 3

The Worked Example: Before and After

The pair from the timed cold-navigation exercise: same content, same course, same three facts to find (exam coverage, review due date, calculator policy). The difference is design, and it's measured in seconds.

Hi everyone, I hope the semester is going well for you so far. I wanted to take a minute to give you some updates about where we are in the course and what is coming up over the next two weeks, because there are several important things happening and I want to make sure everyone is on the same page. First, thank you to everyone who came to the review session last week, I know Thursdays are hard for a lot of you with work schedules and I appreciate the effort. We had a good turnout and worked through a lot of the factoring material together.

As you know we have been working through Chapter 3 and the beginning of Chapter 4, and that brings me to the exam. Exam 2 will be given in class on Thursday, October 23. The exam will cover sections 3.1 through 3.6 and sections 4.1 and 4.2, so everything on quadratic functions, polynomial operations, factoring strategies, rational expressions, and the introduction to rational equations. It will not cover section 4.3, we will start that after the exam. The exam is worth 100 points and you will have the full class period. Please arrive on time because I cannot give extra time at the end, the next class needs the room.

IMPORTANT: THERE IS A REVIEW ASSIGNMENT. The review assignment is posted in MyMathLab and it is due Tuesday, October 21 at 11:59 PM. It is worth 20 points and it is the single best predictor of how you will do on the exam, I say this every semester and every semester the students who skip it are the ones who struggle. Please do not skip it. If you are having trouble logging in to MyMathLab [CLICK HERE](#).

A few notes on exam logistics. You may use a scientific calculator, specifically the TI-30XS or anything comparable, but graphing calculators with CAS capability are not allowed and phones may not be used as calculators under any circumstances, they need to be put away entirely. Bring a pencil, we will provide scratch paper. If you have a documented accommodation through the Center for Disability Services please make sure your testing arrangements are confirmed with them by Monday so everything is set up in time.

Also, my office hours this week are moved from Wednesday to Friday 10 to 12 because of a department meeting, same office, and the Learning Center in the library has drop-in math tutoring Monday through Thursday 9 AM to 7 PM and Friday 9 to 2. The tutors have seen our exam before and they are genuinely helpful, I would use them if the review assignment gives you trouble.

If you miss the exam you must contact me within 48 hours with documentation to be eligible for a makeup, otherwise the exam is scored as a zero per the syllabus policy.

Let me know if you have any questions. See you Tuesday.

The buried dates, the "CLICK HERE" link, and the low-contrast makeup-policy line are each a checklist failure with a name.

Exam 2 — Thursday, October 23 (in class)

100 points · full class period · arrive on time (no extra time at the end)

What the exam covers

- **Sections 3.1-3.6:** quadratic functions, polynomial operations, factoring strategies
- **Sections 4.1-4.2:** rational expressions and introduction to rational equations
- **Not covered:** section 4.3 (starts after the exam)

Before the exam

Review assignment due Tuesday, October 21, 11:59 PM — 20 points, in MyMathLab. It is the single best predictor of exam performance. Do not skip it.

Trouble logging in? [Get MyMathLab login help from the campus tech support page.](#)

Exam day rules

Calculator	TI-30XS or comparable scientific calculator. No CAS graphing calculators. No phones.
Bring	A pencil. Scratch paper is provided.
Accommodations	Confirm testing arrangements with the Center for Disability Services by Monday.
If you miss it	Contact me within 48 hours with documentation to be eligible for a makeup; otherwise the exam is scored as zero (syllabus policy).

Help before the exam

- **Office hours (this week only):** moved to Friday, 10:00–12:00, same office.
- **Learning Center drop-in math tutoring (library):** Mon–Thu 9:00 AM–7:00 PM, Fri 9:00 AM–2:00 PM. The tutors know our exams.

Questions? Message me in Canvas. See you Tuesday.

Headings start at h2, every text/background pair meets 4.5:1, links say where they go, emoji decorate but never carry meaning, inline styles only.

Announcements

An announcement is a page: same sanitizer, same constraint block, same checklist. What's different is the rhythm — announcements repeat weekly, so the win is a template you refill in minutes, not a one-off.

Anatomy of a weekly announcement

Header (course + week number + title) · intro of one or two sentences · an exam-alert box you **keep on exam weeks and delete otherwise** · a coverage card for the week's topics · linked resources · office hours with a booking link · a friendly footer with an email button. Students learn the rhythm and start actually reading; let special occasions (holidays, exam weeks) deliberately break the template so they read as "this one is different."

Turning the first success into a system

Once one announcement looks right, ask the AI to convert it into a reusable template: loud [PLACEHOLDERS] for everything that changes weekly, a to-do checklist inside an HTML comment at the top (comments never display to students), and notes on the variants (exam week vs. regular week). After that, each week is fill-and-post — no AI required.

Images and banners

Three rules keep them working: **host the image in Canvas** (upload to Course Files; a local filename resolves to nothing) · **right-size before uploading** (about 2× the display width, saved as a quality-85 JPEG) · **alt text states what the image says**, not that it exists. Skip base64-embedded images; they bloat the page and misbehave in Canvas.

The starter template lives in the drive folder as `canvas_announcement_starter_template_v2.md`: a complete Canvas-safe announcement plus the constraint block. Build from that file; it corrects an h1 that appeared in an earlier printing.

Pages and Hubs

For resource hubs, video pages, and chapter directories, three architectures cover nearly everything. Honest trade-offs included, because every option has one.

Architecture	How it works	The trade-off
A · Section page	One-stop shop for one section: header, short overview, tappable anchor menu, embedded videos, buttons for slides and skill check, back-to-menu links.	The workhorse when a section has enough content to deserve its own page.
B · Chapter directory	A light launcher that embeds nothing: one card per section with color-coded tiles linking out.	The safest default. Nothing can break; a student pays one extra click.
C · All-in-one hub	The whole chapter on one page, kept compact with closed-by-default <details> panels and lazy-loaded video embeds.	Most convenient, but only after the <details> paste-test passes at your institution. Default to B until it does.

Two techniques worth copying exactly

Anchor navigation, the engine of a one-stop page: a menu of `href="#videos"` links up top, matching `id="videos"` sections below, a small "back to menu" link at the end of each section. No JavaScript, survives every paste.

Responsive video embeds, the fix for the phone problem. A fixed-size embed overflows on phones; this wrapper scales to any screen and `loading="lazy"` keeps multi-video pages fast:

```
<div style="max-width:720px; margin:0 auto;">
  <div style="position:relative; padding-bottom:56.25%; height:0; overflow:hidden;
    border-radius:8px; background:#000;">
    <iframe src="YOUR_VIDEO_EMBED_URL" title="Lecture video"
      loading="lazy" frameborder="0" allowfullscreen
      style="position:absolute; top:0; left:0; width:100%; height:100%; border:0;">
    </iframe>
```

```
</div>  
</div>
```

Videos embed inline; slides and quizzes get a prominent button that opens in a new tab, because a .pptx URL is not a web page and quizzes live in Canvas's own tool.

Color as wayfinding

The highest-leverage design decision: **color encodes resource type, consistently, everywhere.** Pick one hue per type (say, one for slides, one for videos, one for skill checks) on a calm neutral frame, and keep it identical across every chapter. A student learns the code once and orients by hue. Two rules keep it honest: never rely on color alone (every tile also carries an icon and a text label), and consistency beats novelty — students should feel like they're in one designed course, not twelve experiments.

PART 4

Troubleshooting Quick Reference

When a paste goes wrong, the cause is almost always on this table.

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
Page renders as plain text and default bullets	A <code><style></code> block or your own CSS classes were stripped, or you pasted into the visual editor. Rebuild with inline styles; paste and save from the HTML view.
Bold text, spacing tweaks, or shadows vanish but the layout survives	Your institution strips certain properties even inline. Use <code></code> , TYPED CAPITALS, and shadow-free design instead.
Fonts look different from the preview	An external font import was stripped. Switch to Georgia or Arial system stacks.
Image shows a broken icon	The <code>src</code> points to a local filename. Upload to Canvas Files and use its Canvas URL.
Layout crushes or scrolls sideways on phones	@media queries were stripped. Use flex-wrap or grid auto-fit layouts, and the responsive embed wrapper for videos.
Collapsible sections render permanently expanded	Your sanitizer strips <code><details></code> . Use architecture B (the directory) instead.
Links go nowhere	A [PLACEHOLDER] was never replaced. Search the HTML for "[" before posting.
Nothing survives even via the HTML editor	Your institution runs stricter-than-default filtering. Ask your Canvas admin about the allowlist.

PART 5

Your Reflection Log

A blank copy of the log from the session close.

Session Reflection Log

Your Page, Rebuilt — July 16, 2026

Copy this into a shared doc before the session. The participant writes; their words, not the facilitator's. This log is the first data artifact of the monitoring plan (Component 5.4).

Participant (role only, no name needed): Gateway mathematics instructor, AUM **Page worked on today:**

1. What worked? *(What in the last hour actually helped — a tier, a template, the frame, the swap test?)*

2. What will you try? *(Name the specific page and the date it goes live. A commitment with a name and a date, not an intention.)*

Page: Goes live on:

3. What questions remain? *(What would you need answered before doing this without a coach in the room?)*

First review (scheduled at session close): within two weeks of the page above going live — a fifteen-minute conversation, at a time you pick.

PART 5

Links: Rewatch, Re-Ask, Revisit

The intro video (about seven minutes)

The privacy rule, writing your brief, surviving the Canvas sanitizer, accessibility, and turning a first success into a weekly template, walked through using a course announcement as the example. The workflow is identical for any page you build: exam-info pages, weekly modules, video pages. For the announcement-specific pieces this video ends on, see the Announcements playbook in Part 4.



Watch the intro video (Google Drive)

drive.google.com/file/d/1KX_pTZhlk5IB0XpM-Dauelewt9IXklqw/view

The NotebookLM notebook

A notebook loaded with this session's source materials. Ask it questions in plain English — "what survives the Canvas sanitizer?", "what goes in the constraint block?" — and it answers from these documents with citations back to them.



Open the notebook

notebooklm.google.com/notebook/dd8bee33-e2e0-476d-8546-da435296c777

Three steps: 1) open the link (a Google account is required; your AUM account works), 2) type a question in the chat box, 3) follow the numbered citations back to the source passage before you rely on an answer. Same rule as everywhere else in this toolkit: the notebook's answers are a starting point, and the checklist is the verdict.